

# Word family: \*\*assignment / assignments / assign / assigned / assigning / assignee / assignor\*\*

\*\*Base word:\*\* assignment

\*\*Part of speech:\*\* mainly \*\*noun\*\*

\*\*Related forms:\*\*

\* \*\*assignment\*\* (n.) — 作業；任務；指派；分配；派任；轉讓

\* \*\*assign\*\* (v.) — 分配；指派；指定；派任；歸因於

\* \*\*assigned\*\* (adj./participle) — 被指派的；指定的；獲分配的

\* \*\*assignee\*\* (n.) — 受讓人；被指派者

\* \*\*assignor\*\* (n.) — 轉讓人

\* \*\*reassign\*\* (v.) — 重新指派；重新分配

\* \*\*reassignment\*\* (n.) — 重新指派；重新調任

\*\*Useful expressions / extensions:\*\*

\* \*\*school assignment\*\*

\* \*\*written assignment\*\*

\* \*\*group assignment\*\*

\* \*\*submit an assignment\*\*

\* \*\*hand in an assignment\*\*

\* \*\*complete an assignment\*\*

\* \*\*assignment deadline\*\*

\* \*\*work assignment\*\*

\* \*\*job assignment\*\*

\* \*\*special assignment\*\*

\* \*\*military assignment\*\*

\* \*\*assign a task\*\*

\* \*\*assign someone to something\*\*

\* \*\*assign something to someone\*\*

\* \*\*assign a role\*\*

\* \*\*assign responsibility\*\*

\* \*\*assign blame\*\*

\* \*\*assign a value\*\*

\* \*\*assign a number\*\*

\* \*\*assign a cause\*\*

\* \*\*assign rights\*\*

\* \*\*assignment of rights\*\*

\* \*\*on assignment\*\*

\* \*\*reassignment\*\*

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## Meaning in this passage

> The turning point came after I nearly missed an important **assignment** because I had underestimated how long it would take.

Here, **assignment** means:

### **a piece of academic work that a student is required to complete — 作業；課業**

It refers to university work that had to be completed and submitted by a deadline.

**中文翻譯：**

真正的轉捩點，是有一次我差點錯過一份很重要的**作業**，因為我低估了它所需要的時間。

So here:

### **assignment = 老師或課程要求學生完成並通常需要提交的學習任務**

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# 1. **assignment ( 學校 / 大學作業 ) — 作業；課業**

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

### Practice 1 — original sentence

> I nearly missed an important **assignment**.

我差點錯過一份很重要的**作業**。

### Practice 2

> We have a written **assignment** due next Friday.

我們有一份書面**作業**要在下星期五前提交。

### Practice 3

> The **assignment** counts for thirty percent of the final grade.

這份**作業**佔總成績百分之三十。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**assignment = 老師或課程要求學生完成並提交的一項學習工作**

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## # 2. \*\*school / university assignment — 學校 / 大學作業\*\*

### ### Practice 1

> This \*\*university assignment\*\* requires research.

這份\*\*大學作業\*\*需要做資料搜集。

### ### Practice 2

> She spent the weekend finishing a \*\*school assignment\*\*.

她整個週末都在完成一份\*\*學校作業\*\*。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*school/university assignment = 教育課程正式要求學生完成的工作\*\***

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## # 3. \*\*written assignment — 書面作業\*\*

### ### Practice 1

> We have to submit a \*\*written assignment\*\*.

我們要提交一份\*\*書面作業\*\*。

### ### Practice 2

> The course includes two \*\*written assignments\*\*.

這個課程包括兩份\*\*書面作業\*\*。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*written assignment = 以書面形式完成和提交的課業\*\***

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## # 4. \*\*group assignment — 小組作業\*\*

### ### Practice 1

> Our \*\*group assignment\*\* was quite demanding.

我們的\*\*小組作業\*\*要求很高。

### ### Practice 2

> Everyone had a different role in the **group assignment**.

每個人在**小組作業**中都有不同角色。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**group assignment** = 由多名學生合作完成的課業

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# 5. **submit / hand in an assignment** — 提交作業

### ### Practice 1

> I submitted the **assignment** just before the deadline.

我在截止日期前剛好提交了**作業**。

### ### Practice 2

> Don't forget to **hand in your assignment**.

別忘了**交作業**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**submit/hand in an assignment** = 正式把完成的作業交給老師或課程系統

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# 6. **complete / finish an assignment** — 完成作業

### ### Practice 1

> It took me three hours to **complete the assignment**.

我花了三小時才**完成這份作業**。

### ### Practice 2

> She stayed up late to **finish her assignment**.

她熬夜**完成作業**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**complete an assignment** = 把指定的課業全部做完

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# 7. **assignment deadline** — 作業截止日期

### Practice 1

> I wrote the **assignment deadline** in my planner.

我把**作業截止日期**寫進記事簿。

### Practice 2

> Missing an **assignment deadline** can affect your grade.

錯過**作業截止日期**可能影響成績。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**assignment deadline** = 作業最遲必須提交的日期或時間

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# 8. **assignment ( 工作任務 )** — 任務；工作安排

A major broader sense.

### Practice 1

> My manager gave me a new **assignment**.

經理給了我一項新**任務**。

### Practice 2

> The reporter completed the **assignment** successfully.

記者成功完成了這項**採訪任務**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**assignment** = 正式交給某人負責完成的一項工作或任務

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# 9. **work assignment** — 工作任務

### Practice 1

> I received a difficult **work assignment**.

我收到一項困難的**工作任務**。

#### ### Practice 2

> Each employee was given a different **assignment**.

每名員工都獲分配不同**任務**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**work assignment** = 在工作中由上司或機構分配給某人的任務

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# 10. **special assignment** — 特別任務

#### ### Practice 1

> She was sent overseas on a **special assignment**.

她被派往海外執行一項**特別任務**。

#### ### Practice 2

> He is working on a **special assignment** for the director.

他正在為主管執行一項**特別任務**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**special assignment** = 額外、重要或不同於日常工作的特別任務

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# 11. **on assignment** — 正在執行任務

Common in journalism and professional contexts.

#### ### Practice 1

> The photographer is abroad **on assignment**.

那名攝影師正在海外**執行採訪任務**。

#### ### Practice 2

> She spent three weeks in Tokyo **\*\*on assignment\*\***.

她因**\*\*工作任務\*\***在東京逗留了三星期。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*on assignment = 因被正式派去完成某項工作而身處某地或執行任務\*\***

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# 12. **\*\*assignment ( 派任 ; 調任 ) — 派任 ; 工作地點 / 職務安排\*\***

A related institutional sense.

### Practice 1

> His next **\*\*assignment\*\*** will be in Singapore.

他的下一項**\*\*派任\*\***會在新加坡。

### Practice 2

> She accepted an overseas **\*\*assignment\*\***.

她接受了一項海外**\*\*派任\*\***。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*assignment = 某人被正式安排到某個職位、地點或工作崗位的安排\*\***

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# 13. **\*\*military assignment — 軍事派任 ; 駐派\*\***

### Practice 1

> He received a new **\*\*military assignment\*\***.

他收到新的**\*\*軍事派任\*\***。

### Practice 2

> Her overseas **\*\*assignment\*\*** lasted two years.

她的海外**\*\*駐派任務\*\***持續了兩年。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*military assignment = 軍方正式安排的職務、崗位或駐派任務\*\***

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# 14. **\*\*assign something to someone — 把某事分配給某人\*\***

### Practice 1

> The teacher **\*\*assigned each student a topic\*\***.

老師給每名學生**\*\*分配了一個題目\*\***。

### Practice 2

> The manager **\*\*assigned the task to me\*\***.

經理把這項任務**\*\*指派給我\*\***。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*assign X to someone = 正式把 X 交給某人負責\*\***

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# 15. **\*\*assign someone to something — 指派某人負責某事 / 到某處\*\***

### Practice 1

> She was **\*\*assigned to the new project\*\***.

她被**\*\*指派參與新項目\*\***。

### Practice 2

> Two officers were **\*\*assigned to the case\*\***.

兩名警員被**\*\*指派處理案件\*\***。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*assign someone to X = 正式安排某人負責 X 或加入 X\*\***

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# 16. **\*\*assign a task — 分派任務\*\***

### Practice 1

> The supervisor **assigned tasks** to each team member.

主管給每名組員**分派任務**。

#### ### Practice 2

> We should **assign the hardest task** first.

我們應先**分配最困難的任務**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**assign a task** = 正式決定由誰負責完成某項工作

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# 17. **assign a role** — 指派角色

#### ### Practice 1

> Each student was **assigned a role**.

每名學生都被**分配一個角色**。

#### ### Practice 2

> She was **assigned the role of team leader**.

她被**指派擔任組長**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**assign a role** = 正式指定某人在團體或活動中擔任某個角色

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# 18. **assign responsibility** — 分配責任；指定負責人

#### ### Practice 1

> The manager **assigned responsibility** for the report to Kevin.

經理把報告的**責任交給 Kevin**。

#### ### Practice 2

> It is important to **assign responsibility clearly**.

清楚\*\*分配責任\*\*很重要。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*assign responsibility = 正式決定某人需要對某項工作或結果負責\*\***

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# 19. **\*\*assign blame — 歸責；把責任歸咎於\*\***

A figurative evaluative use.

### Practice 1

> It is too early to **\*\*assign blame\*\***.

現在就**\*\*追究責任\*\***還太早。

### Practice 2

> The investigation did not attempt to **\*\*assign blame\*\***.

調查並沒有試圖**\*\*判定誰應負責\*\***。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*assign blame = 決定某人或某因素應對壞結果負責\*\***

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# 20. **\*\*assign a value — 指定 / 賦予數值\*\***

A major mathematical/technical sense.

### Practice 1

> **\*\*Assign a value\*\*** to each variable.

為每個變數**\*\*指定一個數值\*\***。

### Practice 2

> The system **\*\*assigns a score\*\*** to every response.

系統會為每個回答**\*\*給予一個分數\*\***。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*assign a value = 正式決定某個變數、項目或對象應具有哪個數值\*\***

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# 21. **\*\*assign a number / code / label — 編配號碼 / 代碼 / 標籤\*\***

### Practice 1

> Each applicant is **\*\*assigned a number\*\***.

每名申請人都獲**\*\*編配一個號碼\*\***。

### Practice 2

> The system automatically **\*\*assigns a code\*\*** to each file.

系統會自動為每個檔案**\*\*編配代碼\*\***。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*assign a number/code/label = 正式給某個對象一個識別用的數字、代碼或名稱\*\***

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# 22. **\*\*assign a cause / meaning — 把原因 / 意義歸於.....\*\***

An abstract sense.

### Practice 1

> Researchers **\*\*assigned the change to several factors\*\***.

研究人員把這個改變**\*\*歸因於幾個因素\*\***。

### Practice 2

> People often **\*\*assign meaning to random events\*\***.

人們常會**\*\*賦予隨機事件某種意義\*\***。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*assign X to Y = 認為某個原因、意義、價值或性質屬於 Y\*\***

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# 23. **\*\*assignment ( 法律：權利 / 財產轉讓 ) — 轉讓\*\***

A distinct legal/business sense.

#### ### Practice 1

> The contract allows the **assignment of rights**.

合約容許**權利轉讓**。

#### ### Practice 2

> The **assignment** must be made in writing.

這項**轉讓**必須以書面形式進行。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**assignment = 法律上把權利、利益、合約權益或財產轉移給另一方的行為**

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#### # 24. **assignment of rights — 權利轉讓**

#### ### Practice 1

> The agreement covers the **assignment of intellectual property rights**.

協議涵蓋**知識產權轉讓**。

#### ### Practice 2

> Written consent is required for the **assignment of rights**.

**權利轉讓**需要書面同意。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**assignment of rights = 正式把某項法律權利轉交給另一人或機構**

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#### # 25. **assignee — 受讓人；被指派者**

Mostly legal/business in its clearest modern use.

#### ### Practice 1

> The **assignee** receives the contractual rights.

**受讓人**取得合約權利。

#### ### Practice 2

> The document identifies the original owner and the **assignee**.

文件列明原擁有人和**受讓人**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**assignee = 接受被轉讓權利、財產或利益的人或機構**

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# 26. **assignor — 轉讓人**

#### ### Practice 1

> The **assignor** transferred the rights to another company.

**轉讓人**把權利轉給另一家公司。

#### ### Practice 2

> Both the **assignor** and assignee signed the document.

**轉讓人**和受讓人都簽署了文件。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**assignor = 把法律權利或利益轉讓給另一方的人或機構**

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# 27. **reassign — 重新指派；重新分配**

#### ### Practice 1

> The manager **reassigned the task** to another employee.

經理把任務**重新指派**給另一名員工。

#### ### Practice 2

> She was **reassigned to another department**.

她被**調派**到另一個部門。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**\*\*reassign = 把某個任務、角色、職位或人重新安排給另一對象或地方\*\***

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# 28. **\*\*reassignment — 重新指派；調任\*\***

### Practice 1

> His **\*\*reassignment\*\*** took effect immediately.

他的**\*\*調任\*\***即時生效。

### Practice 2

> The workload changed after the **\*\*reassignment of duties\*\***.

職責**\*\*重新分配\*\***後，工作量有所改變。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*reassignment = 重新安排任務、職務、責任或工作地點的行為\*\***

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# Important distinction 1: **\*\*assignment vs homework\*\***

### **\*\*homework\*\***

general schoolwork done outside class; usually uncountable.

> I have a lot of homework.

我有很多功課。

### **\*\*assignment\*\***

a specific piece of work formally given to you; countable.

> I have three assignments.

我有三份作業。

For university English, **\*\*assignment\*\*** is especially common.

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# Important distinction 2: **\*\*assignment vs task\*\***

### ### \*\*task\*\*

any piece of work that needs doing.

### ### \*\*assignment\*\*

work that has been **formally given to someone**.

> Cleaning the desk is a task.

清理書桌是一項任務。

> The professor gave us an assignment.

教授給了我們一份作業。

So **assignment** carries a stronger idea of **being assigned**.

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### # Important distinction 3: **assignment vs project**

#### ### \*\*assignment\*\*

often a defined piece of work with instructions and a deadline.

#### ### \*\*project\*\*

usually larger, longer, and involves several stages.

A project can itself be an assignment.

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### # Important distinction 4: **assignment vs essay**

#### ### \*\*essay\*\*

a particular written form.

#### ### \*\*assignment\*\*

broader.

An assignment may be:

- \* an essay,
- \* a presentation,
- \* a report,
- \* a design task,
- \* a group project.

So:

### \*\*every essay may be an assignment, but not every assignment is an essay\*\*

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# Important distinction 5: \*\*assignment vs exercise\*\*

### \*\*exercise\*\*

usually shorter practice activity.

### \*\*assignment\*\*

more substantial formally required work.

> grammar exercise

> 文法練習

> research assignment

> 研究作業

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# Important distinction 6: \*\*assignment is countable\*\*

Correct:

> an assignment

> two assignments

> a lot of assignments

Unlike \*\*homework\*\*:

> a lot of homework 

> \*two homeworks\*  in standard English

This is a very useful learner distinction.

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# Important distinction 7: **submit vs hand in an assignment**

### **submit**

more formal and especially common for online/university work.

### **hand in**

more conversational and traditionally physical, though it can be used more broadly.

> submit via Moodle

> 透過系統提交

> hand in to the teacher

> 交給老師

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# Important distinction 8: **assign something to someone vs assign someone something**

Both are possible:

> assign the task **to Kevin**

> assign Kevin **the task**

Both mean:

### **把任務分配給 Kevin**

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# Important distinction 9: **assign someone to a task vs assign a task to someone**

Compare:

> assign **Kevin to the project**

> 指派 Kevin 參與項目

> assign **the project to Kevin**

> 把項目交給 Kevin 負責

The grammatical focus changes.

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# Important distinction 10: **assign vs appoint**

### **assign**

give a task, duty, role, or location.

### **appoint**

formally select someone for an official position.

> assign her a task

> 分派她一項任務

> appoint her manager

> 任命她為經理

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# Important distinction 11: **assign vs allocate**

### **assign**

often person ↔ responsibility/task.

### **allocate**

often resources ↔ amount/purpose.

> assign a task to Kevin

> 把任務交給 Kevin

> allocate money to the project

> 撥款給項目

They overlap, but the typical objects differ.

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# Important distinction 12: **assign vs designate**

### **assign**

give responsibility or attach something.

### \*\*designate\*\*

officially name/select for a purpose.

> assign a role

> 分配角色

> designate an area as a safety zone

> 指定某區為安全區

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# Important distinction 13: \*\*assignment as job vs assignment as academic work\*\*

Compare:

> I have an assignment due tomorrow.

> 我明天要交一份\*\*作業\*\*。

> I'm going to Berlin on assignment.

> 我要去柏林\*\*執行工作任務\*\*。

Same noun, clearly different contexts.

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# Important distinction 14: \*\*assignment vs reassignment\*\*

### \*\*assignment\*\*

first/current allocation.

### \*\*reassignment\*\*

allocation is changed.

> assignment to Team A

> 獲派到 A 組

> reassignment to Team B

> 重新調派到 B 組

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# Important distinction 15: \*\*assignment in law\*\*

The legal meaning is not “homework” or “work task.”

### \*\*assignment = transfer of a legal right or interest\*\*

This should be kept as a clearly separate specialist sense because it is established and common in contracts/business law.

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# Family-extension note

The \*\*assignment\*\* family has a very clear semantic core:

### \*\*something is formally given, allocated, or attached to someone/something\*\*

From that core come several branches:

### 1. \*\*academic work\*\*

- \* assignment
- \* written assignment
- \* submit an assignment

### 2. \*\*work duty\*\*

- \* work assignment
- \* special assignment
- \* on assignment

### 3. \*\*role / responsibility allocation\*\*

- \* assign a task
- \* assign a role
- \* assign responsibility

### 4. \*\*placement\*\*

- \* assign someone to a team/location

### 5. \*\*values / labels\*\*

- \* assign a number
- \* assign a value
- \* assign a code

### 6. \*\*abstract attribution\*\*

- \* assign meaning
- \* assign blame

#### ### 7. \*\*legal transfer\*\*

- \* assignment of rights
- \* assignee
- \* assignor

#### ### 8. \*\*redistribution\*\*

- \* reassign
- \* reassignment

For your passage, the exact branch is:

### \*\*assignment = a specific piece of university coursework that had to be completed and submitted\*\*

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#### # Master comparison

| Form / expression         | Traditional Chinese | Core idea                |  |
|---------------------------|---------------------|--------------------------|--|
| -----                     | -----               | -----                    |  |
| **assignment** (academic) | 作業；課業               | required student work    |  |
| **written assignment**    | 書面作業                | written coursework       |  |
| **group assignment**      | 小組作業                | collaborative coursework |  |
| **submit an assignment**  | 提交作業                | formal submission        |  |
| **assignment deadline**   | 作業截止日期              | due time                 |  |
| **assignment** (work)     | 工作任務                | formally given duty      |  |
| **special assignment**    | 特別任務                | unusual/important duty   |  |
| **on assignment**         | 正在執行任務              | professional duty        |  |
| **assignment** (posting)  | 派任；調派               | role/location            |  |
| **assign X to someone**   | 把 X 分配給某人           | allocation               |  |
| **assign someone to X**   | 指派某人負責 X            | placement                |  |
| **assign a task**         | 分派任務                | duty allocation          |  |
| **assign a role**         | 指派角色                | role allocation          |  |
| **assign responsibility** | 分配責任                | responsibility           |  |
| **assign blame**          | 歸責                  | attribution              |  |
| **assign a value**        | 指定數值                | technical allocation     |  |
| **assign a code**         | 編配代碼                | identification           |  |
| **assign meaning**        | 賦予意義                | abstract attribution     |  |
| **assignment of rights**  | 權利轉讓                | legal transfer           |  |
| **assignee**              | 受讓人                 | receives rights          |  |

|                  |         |                  |  |
|------------------|---------|------------------|--|
| **assignor**     | 轉讓人     | transfers rights |  |
| **reassign**     | 重新指派    | allocate again   |  |
| **reassignment** | 重新指派；調任 | new allocation   |  |

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### For your original sentence

> The turning point came after I nearly missed an important \*\*assignment\*\* because I had underestimated how long it would take.

Here:

### \*\*assignment\*\* = 大學課程正式要求完成並在指定日期前提交的一份作業\*\*

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 真正的轉捩點，是有一次我差點錯過一份很重要的\*\*作業\*\*，因為我低估了它所需要的時間。

The key contrast is:

> \*\*homework\*\* = 泛指功課，通常不可數

> \*\*assignment\*\* = \*\*一份具體、正式分派、通常有截止期限的課業\*\*

> \*\*task\*\* = 任何需要完成的任務

> \*\*project\*\* = 通常較大型、較長期、分多個步驟

For this university passage, \*\*assignment\*\* is the most precise word because it refers to a \*\*specific assessed piece of coursework\*\*.